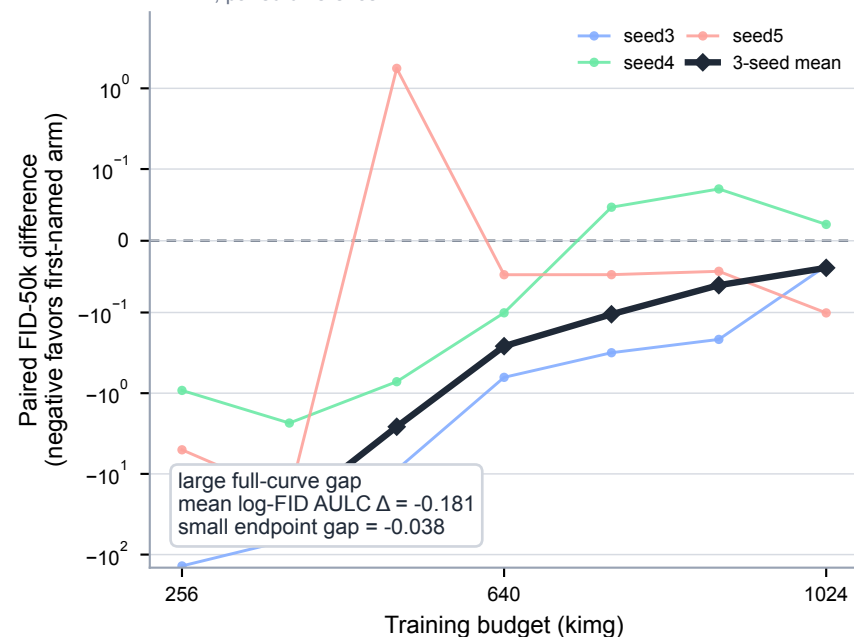


Cross-dataset quality emergence: finite-budget effects converge, reverse, or destabilize

Thin colored lines are individual training seeds; the dark line is the stated descriptive mean. Symlog y-scales preserve both near-zero endpoints and large early/unstable excursions.

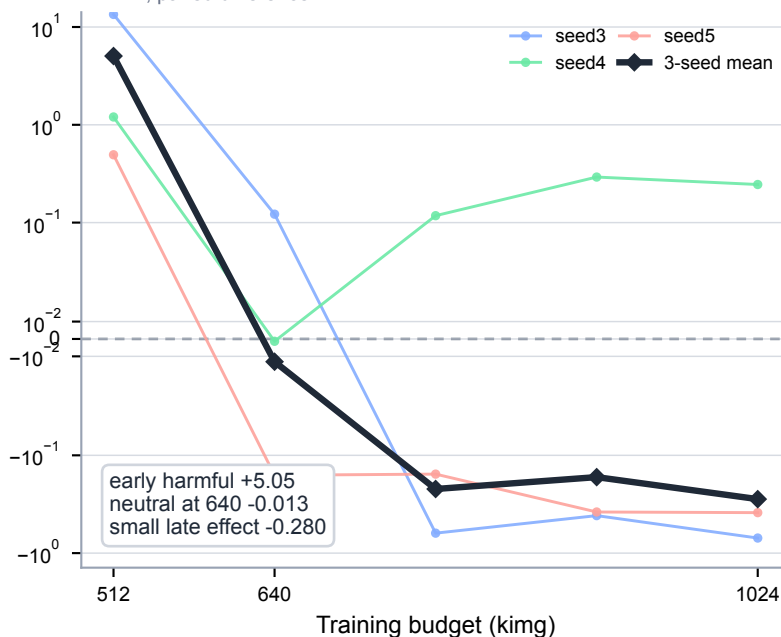
A q256

NFE=2; paired difference B - A



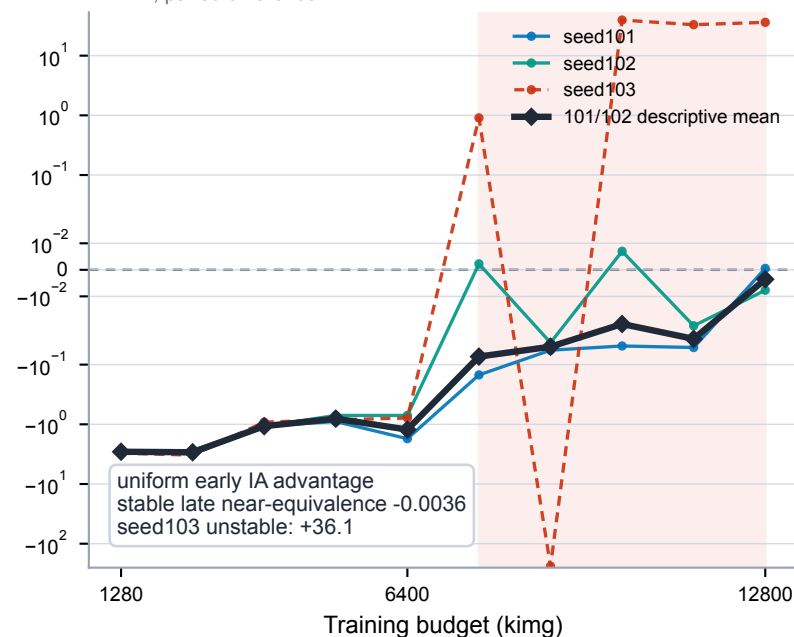
B q128

NFE=1; paired difference B - A



C ImageNet-64

NFE=2; paired difference IA - IB



Note. Panels use different arm contrasts and NFE settings, stated above each axis; the figure synthesizes trajectory shape rather than a pooled effect. q256 AULC is a deterministic normalized trapezoidal area under log FID. The ImageNet 101/102 mean is a post hoc sensitivity summary; seed103 remains displayed and is not interpreted after instability.